

EMPLOYEE IT GUIDES

Practical self-service instructions for accounts, devices, connectivity,
collaboration, printing, and security

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How to Use This Guide

This document is structured for both employees and retrieval-based assistants. Each guide has a unique topic, direct steps, success checks, and escalation criteria. Follow company security policy if it conflicts with a local device prompt.

Need	Start here
Cannot sign in	1. Account access and password reset
MFA prompt or new phone	2. Multi-factor authentication
No internet or VPN	3-4. Wi-Fi and VPN
Slow or frozen computer	5. Device troubleshooting
Email or meeting problem	6-7. Email, calendar, Teams
Printer problem	8. Printing and scanning
Possible security incident	9. Security incidents - act immediately
Need software or access	10. Software and access requests
Need IT help	11. Support and escalation

General rule: Never share your password, MFA code, recovery code, or confidential data with anyone, including someone claiming to be IT. Approved IT staff will not ask for these secrets.

1. Account Access and Password Reset

Purpose: Restore access to your company account safely.

Before you start

- If you receive an unexpected password-reset email, do not click it. Report it as suspicious.

Steps

1. Check Caps Lock, keyboard language, and that you are using your full company email address.
2. Use the approved **Forgot password** or self-service password reset link on the company sign-in page.
3. Verify your identity using your registered MFA method. Never approve an unexpected MFA prompt.
4. Create a unique password or passphrase that meets the requirements shown on screen. Do not reuse personal passwords.
5. Sign in again. Update saved credentials in approved apps only; do not store passwords in notes or browsers that are not company-managed.

How to confirm it worked

- You can sign in to the company portal and email.
- No repeated lockout message appears.

Escalate when

- Your account remains locked after the stated lockout period.
- Your registered MFA method is unavailable.
- You suspect somebody changed your password or accessed your account.

2. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

Purpose: Register, use, or recover an approved second verification factor.

Steps

1. Open the company security settings from a trusted, company-approved device.
2. Choose **Add sign-in method** and select the method permitted by company policy.
3. Follow the QR-code or phone-registration instructions. Confirm the test prompt.
4. Register a backup method if policy allows it, then store recovery information securely.
5. When replacing a phone, register the new device before removing the old one whenever possible.

How to confirm it worked

- A test sign-in succeeds using the registered factor.
- The new method appears in your security settings.

Escalate when

- You lost the only registered device.
- MFA prompts arrive when you are not signing in.

- The verification loop repeats or shows an unknown device.

3. Office Wi-Fi Connection

Purpose: Connect a company-managed laptop or phone to the approved office wireless network.

Before you start

- Do not create personal hotspots to bypass a corporate network restriction unless IT authorizes it.

Steps

1. Turn Wi-Fi on and disable airplane mode.
2. Select the official corporate network name published by IT. Avoid similarly named networks.
3. Authenticate with your company identity or approved certificate when prompted.
4. Accept a certificate only when its organization and details match IT guidance.
5. Open the employee portal to confirm connectivity.

How to confirm it worked

- The device shows the corporate network as connected.
- The employee portal and approved cloud services load.

Escalate when

- The network is missing for multiple nearby users.
- You see certificate warnings or repeated authentication failures.
- The connection drops across different office areas.

4. VPN: Remote Access

Purpose: Connect securely to internal systems while working outside the office.

Before you start

- Do not disable antivirus, firewall, device management, or encryption to make VPN work.

Steps

1. Confirm your regular internet connection works before opening the VPN.
2. Open the company-approved VPN client; do not install a similarly named client from the web.
3. Select the assigned connection profile and sign in with your company account and MFA.
4. Wait until the client shows **Connected**, then open the internal resource.
5. If connection fails, disconnect, restart the client, and try once more. Restart the device if required.

How to confirm it worked

- The VPN status is Connected.
- The required internal application opens.

Escalate when

- MFA succeeds but VPN repeatedly fails.
- You receive certificate, compliance, or access-denied messages.
- Many employees appear affected.

5. Slow, Frozen, or Unresponsive Device

Purpose: Resolve common performance problems without risking company data.

Before you start

- For swelling, smoke, sparks, or liquid exposure: stop using the device, unplug it only if safe, move away, and contact IT/facilities immediately.

Steps

1. Save work if possible. Note the app and action that caused the issue.
2. Close only the unresponsive app. Wait briefly before forcing it to quit.
3. Check that the device has power, adequate free storage, and a stable network connection.
4. Restart the device using the normal restart option. Install pending approved updates when prompted.
5. Reopen only required apps. Record any error message exactly if the issue returns.

How to confirm it worked

- Normal apps open and respond.
- The issue does not return after restart.

Escalate when

- The device will not start, overheats, smells unusual, is swollen, or shows liquid damage.
- The same error returns after restart.
- Files are missing, encrypted unexpectedly, or renamed.

6. Email and Calendar

Purpose: Fix common synchronization, sending, and calendar issues.

Steps

1. Confirm internet access and check whether the email service reports offline mode.
2. Verify the sender/recipient address and check Outbox, Drafts, Junk, and mailbox storage.
3. Restart the approved email application and sign in again only through the official prompt.
4. For calendar issues, confirm the correct time zone and calendar are selected.
5. For a missing invitation, search by organizer or meeting title and ask the organizer to confirm the address used.

How to confirm it worked

- A test email sends and arrives.
- Calendar times match your work location and the meeting appears on the intended calendar.

Escalate when

- Multiple users cannot send or receive.
- A legitimate message is quarantined or confidential mail was sent to the wrong recipient.
- Sign-in prompts look unusual or repeat unexpectedly.

7. Microsoft Teams: Calls and Meetings

Purpose: Resolve common audio, camera, screen-sharing, and presence issues.

Steps

1. Join early and use the device-settings preview to select the correct speaker, microphone, and camera.
2. Confirm the operating system has granted microphone, camera, and screen-recording permissions to Teams.
3. Close other apps that may be using the camera or microphone.
4. Disconnect and rejoin the meeting. If quality is poor, turn off video and close high-bandwidth activity.
5. Restart Teams; use the approved web version as a temporary fallback if company policy permits.

How to confirm it worked

- The test call plays sound and records your voice.
- Camera preview and screen sharing work without exposing unrelated confidential windows.

Escalate when

- Hardware is not detected after restart.
- Meeting recording, transcription, or external access is required but unavailable.
- A confidential meeting link may have been shared externally.

8. Printing and Scanning

Purpose: Use an approved office printer and resolve basic queue problems.

Before you start

- Collect printed originals immediately. Do not photograph or email confidential pages through personal accounts.

Steps

1. Confirm the printer name and location before sending sensitive documents.
2. Check paper, visible error indicators, and your device connection.
3. Open the print queue and cancel only your own stuck jobs.
4. Retry with a one-page non-confidential test document.
5. For scanning, choose an approved destination and verify the file before leaving the device.

How to confirm it worked

- The test page prints once and the queue clears.
- The scan opens correctly and is stored only in the approved location.

Escalate when

- Paper is jammed where removal is not clearly user-accessible.
- Sensitive pages printed at the wrong device.
- The printer shows hardware, toner, or service errors.

9. Security Incidents and Suspicious Activity

Act immediately. Fast reporting matters more than investigating the issue yourself.

Phishing email or message

- Do not click links, open attachments, reply, or forward the message.
- Use the approved **Report phishing** function or contact the IT/security channel.
- If you already interacted, stop and report exactly what happened. Do not hide or delete evidence.

Unexpected MFA prompt

- Deny the prompt.
- Change your password from a trusted device using the official portal.
- Report the time, approximate location, and service shown in the prompt.

Lost or stolen device

- Report it immediately to IT/security and your manager.
- Provide device type, asset tag if known, last known location, time, and whether it was unlocked.
- Do not attempt a risky personal recovery. IT may remotely lock or wipe a managed device.

Malware or ransomware warning

- Disconnect from networks if safe, but do not power off unless instructed.
- Stop using the device and contact IT/security from another device.
- Do not pay, negotiate, install cleanup tools, or connect USB storage.

Accidental data disclosure

- Report the recipient, data type, time, and sharing method immediately.
- Do not rely only on message recall or link removal.
- Follow IT/security instructions and preserve relevant evidence.

Emergency rule: If there is danger to people or property, contact local emergency services and site security first.

10. Software Installation and Access Requests

Purpose: Request approved software, licenses, shared folders, systems, or elevated permissions.

Before you start

- Approval does not guarantee immediate installation. Never install unapproved software, browser extensions, cracked tools, or personal cloud-sync apps.

Steps

1. Search the approved software catalog or access-request portal.
2. Select the exact application, system, shared folder, or role needed.
3. State the business purpose, required access level, project, manager, and requested duration.
4. Submit the request and keep the request ID. Approval may be required from your manager, system owner, security, procurement, or IT.
5. After approval and fulfillment, test only the functions needed for your role. Report excessive access.

How to confirm it worked

- The request status is Approved/Fulfilled.
- You can access the approved resource at the granted level.

Escalate when

- The item is not in the catalog.
- The request is urgent or blocks a critical deadline.
- Granted access is broader than requested.

11. IT Support and Escalation

Purpose: Give IT enough information to diagnose an incident or fulfill a request quickly.

Before you start

- Never include passwords, MFA codes, private keys, recovery codes, full payment-card data, or unnecessary personal/confidential data in a ticket.

Steps

1. Use the approved IT service portal or official support channel. For security incidents, use the security-reporting route immediately.
2. Choose the correct category and describe the expected behavior, actual behavior, and business impact.
3. Include device asset tag, application/service, location, time started, exact error text, troubleshooting already attempted, and safe screenshots.
4. Keep the ticket ID. Add new evidence to the same ticket rather than opening duplicates.
5. Escalate through the service portal when impact or urgency changes.

How to confirm it worked

- You receive a ticket ID and confirmation.
- Status updates appear in the official support channel.

Escalate when

- A security event, safety issue, or major outage is occurring.
- The issue blocks critical work for multiple employees.
- The agreed response target has passed without an update.

12. Ticket Priority Guide

Priority is based on both **impact** (how many people or services are affected) and **urgency** (how quickly harm grows). IT validates the final priority.

Priority	Use when	Examples
P1 - Critical	Organization-wide outage, active severe security/safety event, or critical service unavailable with no workaround.	Major identity outage; active ransomware; core business service down.
P2 - High	Team or important service is significantly affected; deadline-critical work blocked; limited workaround.	Department cannot use VPN; executive/client meeting system unavailable.
P3 - Normal	One or a few employees affected; normal work impaired; workaround may exist.	Laptop is slow; printer unavailable; one application error.
P4 - Low / Request	Information, standard access, planned change, or minor inconvenience.	Software request; shared-folder access; setup guidance.

Ticket information checklist

- Employee name and employee ID
- Device asset tag and operating system
- Application or service name
- Exact error message
- Start time and frequency
- Number of affected users
- Business impact and deadline
- Steps already tried
- Safe screenshot with sensitive information hidden

Knowledge-base answer boundary

This guide provides general self-service instructions. It does not authorize access, approve software, disclose confidential configuration, or replace IT/security decisions. If details are unavailable, the assistant should say so and direct the employee to the approved IT support route rather than inventing a contact, link, response time, or policy.

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Search keywords

password reset; locked account; MFA; authenticator; Wi-Fi; wireless; VPN; remote access; slow laptop; frozen computer; Outlook; email; calendar; Teams; microphone; camera; meeting; printer; scanner; phishing; suspicious email; unexpected MFA; malware; ransomware; lost device; stolen laptop; software installation; access request; IT ticket; ticket priority; escalation

Customization note

Before production use, replace generic references such as “approved portal,” “official support channel,” “corporate network,” and “company-approved VPN” with verified ISYS names, URLs, support hours, and ownership. Keep the generic safety rules even after customization.